

Does your AI feature actually need conversation?

Validate your decision: Conversation Decision Checklist

USE CONVERSATION WHEN

The problem is genuinely ambiguous

User doesn't know exactly what they need; dialogue helps clarify

Learning is the goal, not just output

The dialogue itself is the value (education, coaching, tutorials)

Emotional context matters

Support, journaling, or coaching where user's state is part of it

Extended collaboration is required

Complex creative projects with iteration over time

High stakes require verification

User needs to understand and approve AI reasoning before action

SKIP CONVERSATION WHEN

Intent is clear and action is well-defined

User knows what they want; just do it

Speed matters more than explanation

Waiting for a response feels like friction, not dialogue

Context can be inferred

AI already has what it needs from environment/history

Interaction is repeated frequently

Nobody wants the same conversation daily

Low stakes allow for undo

Faster to act and reverse than to discuss

The principle: Start with minimal interaction. Add conversation only when simpler approaches fail.

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